

SENATE RESOLUTION 34

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Kenneth Whalum III of Memphis.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should salute those citizens who, through their extraordinary efforts and artistic contributions, have distinguished themselves as community leaders of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Kenneth Whalum III of Memphis, a top session and touring saxophonist who rose quickly in the music industry by working with artists who are household names, while also carving out a deep and unique niche as a modern solo artist; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Whalum III hails from the highly respected Whalum family of Memphis, the members of which, over four generations, have distinguished themselves time and again in the fields of music, worship, and public service; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Whalum's musical genre may be most related to alt-soul, but his secret to songwriting is being honest and real, as exemplified by his most recent single, *Say Sorry*, and his deeply emotional 2021 release, *One More Kiss*, which taps straight into the heart of the matter; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Whalum's musical journey began in sixth grade, when he was encouraged by his band director to play the saxophone because of his familial connection to the legendary sax player Kirk Whalum; and

WHEREAS, after pursuing higher education at Morehouse College, in 2004, he enrolled in The New School in New York City, where he honed his musical skills and solidified his dedication to a career in music; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Whalum's music is deeply influenced by the legacy of Memphis music, particularly Gospel and R&B, which have shaped his sound and his understanding of soul music as an expression of personal truth and honesty; and

WHEREAS, his decision to transition from a successful career as a top-level saxophonist to pursuing his own music and singing demonstrates his commitment to artistic liberation and self-expression; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Whalum's collaborations with respected artists such as D'Angelo, the late Mac Miller, and Justine Skye and his performances at prestigious venues like the Hollywood Bowl showcase his versatility and passion for his craft; and

WHEREAS, Kenneth Whalum III epitomizes the spirit and commitment to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that we acknowledge and applaud Mr. Whalum for his commitment to excellence in music and beyond; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we honor and commend Kenneth Whalum III for his indelible contributions to music and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.